

# Tibetan astrology

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**Tibetan astrology** (Tibetan: དཀར་རྩིས་, Wylie: dkar rtsis) is a traditional discipline of the Tibetan peoples that has influence from both Chinese astrology and Hindu astrology. Tibetan astrology is one of the 'Ten Sciences' (Wylie: rig-pa'i gnas bcu; Sanskrit: daśavidyā) in the enumeration honoured by this cultural tradition.<sup>[1]</sup>

In the Tibetan Buddhist medical and tantric traditions, astrology is not regarded as superstition but rather as a practical tool to understand and heal our body and mind on the gross, subtle and very subtle levels. One can experience many sicknesses and misfortunes due to outer, inner and secret astrological reactions as well as malevolent celestial influences. <sup>[2]</sup>

## Year-signs

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The Year-signs cycle in an archetypal progression or continuüm:

- Mouse
- Ox
- Tiger
- Rabbit
- Dragon
- Snake
- Horse
- Sheep
- Monkey
- Bird<sup>[3]</sup>
- Dog
- Pig<sup>[3]</sup>

## Animal signs and elements

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Per:<sup>[4]</sup>

| Year | Animal | Element | Start date  |
|------|--------|---------|-------------|
| 1912 | Mouse  | Water   | 21-Dec-1911 |
| 1913 | Ox     | Water   | 9-Dec-1912  |
| 1914 | Tiger  | Wood    | 28-Dec-1913 |
| 1915 | Rabbit | Wood    | 17-Dec-1914 |
| 1916 | Dragon | Fire    | 7-Dec-1915  |
| 1917 | Snake  | Fire    | 25-Dec-1916 |
| 1918 | Horse  | Earth   | 15-Dec-1917 |
| 1919 | Sheep  | Earth   | 4-Dec-1918  |
| 1920 | Monkey | Iron    | 23-Dec-1919 |
| 1921 | Bird   | Iron    | 11-Dec-1920 |
| 1922 | Dog    | Water   | 30-Dec-1921 |
| 1923 | Pig    | Water   | 19-Dec-1922 |
| 1924 | Mouse  | Wood    | 8-Dec-1923  |
| 1925 | Ox     | Wood    | 26-Dec-1924 |
| 1926 | Tiger  | Fire    | 16-Dec-1925 |
| 1927 | Rabbit | Fire    | 6-Dec-1926  |
| 1928 | Dragon | Earth   | 24-Dec-1927 |
| 1929 | Snake  | Earth   | 12-Dec-1928 |
| 1930 | Horse  | Iron    | 31-Dec-1929 |
| 1931 | Sheep  | Iron    | 20-Dec-1930 |
| 1932 | Monkey | Water   | 10-Dec-1931 |
| 1933 | Bird   | Water   | 28-Dec-1932 |
| 1934 | Dog    | Wood    | 18-Dec-1933 |
| 1935 | Pig    | Wood    | 7-Dec-1934  |
| 1936 | Mouse  | Fire    | 26-Dec-1935 |
| 1937 | Ox     | Fire    | 14-Dec-1936 |
| 1938 | Tiger  | Earth   | 2-Jan-1938  |
| 1939 | Rabbit | Earth   | 22-Dec-1938 |
| 1940 | Dragon | Iron    | 11-Dec-1939 |
| 1941 | Snake  | Iron    | 29-Dec-1940 |
| 1942 | Horse  | Water   | 19-Dec-1941 |
| 1943 | Sheep  | Water   | 8-Dec-1942  |
| 1944 | Monkey | Wood    | 28-Dec-1943 |
| 1945 | Bird   | Wood    | 16-Dec-1944 |
| 1946 | Dog    | Fire    | 5-Dec-1945  |
| 1947 | Pig    | Fire    | 24-Dec-1946 |

|      |        |       |             |
|------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 1948 | Mouse  | Earth | 13-Dec-1947 |
| 1949 | Ox     | Earth | 31-Dec-1948 |
| 1950 | Tiger  | Iron  | 20-Dec-1949 |
| 1951 | Rabbit | Iron  | 10-Dec-1950 |
| 1952 | Dragon | Water | 29-Dec-1951 |
| 1953 | Snake  | Water | 17-Dec-1952 |
| 1954 | Horse  | Wood  | 7-Dec-1953  |
| 1955 | Sheep  | Wood  | 26-Dec-1954 |
| 1956 | Monkey | Fire  | 15-Dec-1955 |
| 1957 | Bird   | Fire  | 1-Jan-1957  |
| 1958 | Dog    | Earth | 22-Dec-1957 |
| 1959 | Pig    | Earth | 11-Dec-1958 |
| 1960 | Mouse  | Iron  | 30-Dec-1959 |
| 1961 | Ox     | Iron  | 19-Dec-1960 |
| 1962 | Tiger  | Water | 8-Dec-1961  |
| 1963 | Rabbit | Water | 27-Dec-1962 |
| 1964 | Dragon | Wood  | 16-Dec-1963 |
| 1965 | Snake  | Wood  | 4-Dec-1964  |
| 1966 | Horse  | Fire  | 23-Dec-1965 |
| 1967 | Sheep  | Fire  | 12-Dec-1966 |
| 1968 | Monkey | Earth | 31-Dec-1967 |
| 1969 | Bird   | Earth | 20-Dec-1968 |
| 1970 | Dog    | Iron  | 10-Dec-1969 |
| 1971 | Pig    | Iron  | 29-Dec-1970 |
| 1972 | Mouse  | Water | 18-Dec-1971 |
| 1973 | Ox     | Water | 6-Dec-1972  |
| 1974 | Tiger  | Wood  | 25-Dec-1973 |
| 1975 | Rabbit | Wood  | 14-Dec-1974 |
| 1976 | Dragon | Fire  | 2-Jan-1976  |
| 1977 | Snake  | Fire  | 21-Dec-1976 |
| 1978 | Horse  | Earth | 11-Dec-1977 |
| 1979 | Sheep  | Earth | 30-Dec-1978 |
| 1980 | Monkey | Iron  | 20-Dec-1979 |
| 1981 | Bird   | Iron  | 8-Dec-1980  |
| 1982 | Dog    | Water | 27-Dec-1981 |
| 1983 | Pig    | Water | 16-Dec-1982 |
| 1984 | Mouse  | Wood  | 4-Jan-1984  |

|      |        |       |             |
|------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 1985 | Ox     | Wood  | 23-Dec-1984 |
| 1986 | Tiger  | Fire  | 12-Dec-1985 |
| 1987 | Rabbit | Fire  | 1-Jan-1987  |
| 1988 | Dragon | Earth | 21-Dec-1987 |
| 1989 | Snake  | Earth | 10-Dec-1988 |
| 1990 | Horse  | Iron  | 28-Dec-1989 |
| 1991 | Sheep  | Iron  | 18-Dec-1990 |
| 1992 | Monkey | Water | 7-Dec-1991  |
| 1993 | Bird   | Water | 24-Dec-1992 |
| 1994 | Dog    | Wood  | 14-Dec-1993 |
| 1995 | Pig    | Wood  | 2-Jan-1995  |
| 1996 | Mouse  | Fire  | 22-Dec-1995 |
| 1997 | Ox     | Fire  | 11-Dec-1996 |
| 1998 | Tiger  | Earth | 30-Dec-1997 |
| 1999 | Rabbit | Earth | 19-Dec-1998 |
| 2000 | Dragon | Iron  | 8-Dec-1999  |
| 2001 | Snake  | Iron  | 26-Dec-2000 |
| 2002 | Horse  | Water | 15-Dec-2001 |
| 2003 | Sheep  | Water | 3-Jan-2003  |
| 2004 | Monkey | Wood  | 24-Dec-2003 |
| 2005 | Bird   | Wood  | 13-Dec-2004 |
| 2006 | Dog    | Fire  | 1-Jan-2006  |
| 2007 | Pig    | Fire  | 21-Dec-2006 |
| 2008 | Mouse  | Earth | 10-Dec-2007 |
| 2009 | Ox     | Earth | 8-Jan-2008  |
| 2010 | Tiger  | Iron  |             |
| 2011 | Rabbit | Iron  |             |
| 2012 | Dragon | Water |             |
| 2013 | Snake  | Water |             |
| 2014 | Horse  | Wood  |             |
| 2015 | Sheep  | Wood  |             |
| 2016 | Monkey | Fire  |             |
| 2017 | Bird   | Fire  |             |
| 2018 | Dog    | Earth |             |
| 2019 | Pig    | Earth |             |
| 2020 | Mouse  | Iron  |             |

\* Note: The start date of Losar depends on what time zone one is in. For example, in 2005, Losar started on February 8 in U.S. time zones and February 9 in Asia time zones. Some people began celebrating Losar on February 9 in the US. The Tibetan new year is based on a fluctuating point that marks the New Moon that is nearest to the beginning of February. Despite their apparent similarities, the start of the Tibetan and Chinese New Years can sometimes differ by a whole month.

## **Favourable and non-favourable days by animal sign**

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This calendar is based on Tibetan astrology and is calculated for midday in European Std Time (GMT+2)

Table below show the days of the weeks (and corresponding planets) that are considered generally favourable or not favourable for the 12 Tibetan astrological signs.<sup>[5]</sup>

For the start of new or important activities it is advisable to **avoid the unfavourable week days** in the calendar.

| <b>Animal Sign</b> | <b>Favourable</b>   | <b>Non Favourable</b> |
|--------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| Mouse              | Wednesday (Mercury) | Saturday (Saturn)     |
| Ox                 | Saturday (Saturn)   | Thursday (Jupiter)    |
| Tiger              | Thursday (Jupiter)  | Friday (Venus)        |
| Rabbit             | Thursday (Jupiter)  | Friday (Venus)        |
| Dragon             | Sunday (Sun)        | Thursday (Jupiter)    |
| Snake              | Tuesday (Mars)      | Wednesday (Mercury)   |
| Horse              | Tuesday (Mars)      | Wednesday (Mercury)   |
| Sheep              | Friday (Venus)      | Thursday (Jupiter)    |
| Monkey             | Friday (Venus)      | Tuesday (Mars)        |
| Bird               | Friday (Venus)      | Tuesday (Mars)        |
| Dog                | Monday (Moon)       | Thursday (Jupiter)    |
| Pig                | Wednesday (Mercury) | Saturday (Saturn)     |

## **Vaidūrya dKar-po (White Beryl)**

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The names of the chapters of the ***Vaidūrya dKar-po*** (the premier Tibetan text on astrological divination) are :

- 1. "Aspects of Turtle Divination ([http://texts.00.gs/Elemental\\_Divination,\\_1.htm](http://texts.00.gs/Elemental_Divination,_1.htm))"
- 2. "Hidden Points ([http://texts.00.gs/Elemental\\_Divination,\\_2.htm](http://texts.00.gs/Elemental_Divination,_2.htm))"
- 3. "Geomantic Aspects ([http://texts.00.gs/Elemental\\_Divination,\\_3.htm](http://texts.00.gs/Elemental_Divination,_3.htm))"
- 10. "The Thirty Computational Charts ([http://texts.00.gs/Elemental\\_Divination,\\_10.htm](http://texts.00.gs/Elemental_Divination,_10.htm))"
- 11. "The Thirteen Charts ([http://texts.00.gs/Elemental\\_Divination,\\_11.htm](http://texts.00.gs/Elemental_Divination,_11.htm))"

## See also

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- [Jyotisha](#) (Indian astrology)
- [Chinese astrology](#)
- [Losar](#)
- [Tibetan calendar](#)
- [Culture of Tibet](#)
- [Tibetan people](#)
- [Tibet](#)
- [Tibet Autonomous Region](#)

## Notes

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1. Dudjom Rinpoche and Jikdrel Yeshe Dorje. *The Nyingma School of Tibetan Buddhism: its Fundamentals and History*. Two Volumes. 1991. Translated and edited by Gyurme Dorje with Matthew Kapstein. Wisdom Publications, Boston. ISBN 0-86171-087-8; Enumerations p.167
2. "Self-Healing II – NgalSo – LGPP" (<http://www.lgpp.org/en/self-healing-ii-ngalso/>). 20 June 2014. Retrieved 2022-08-29.
3. "Tibetan Astrology – Table of Year-Animal-Element | Albagnano Healing Meditation Centre" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20141111060711/http://ahmc.ngalso.net/2014/01/28/tibetan-astrology-table-of-year-animal-element-2/?lang=en>). *ahmc.ngalso.net*. Archived from the original (<http://ahmc.ngalso.net/2014/01/28/tibetan-astrology-table-of-year-animal-element-2/?lang=en>) on 2014-11-11.
4. "Tibetan Astrology – Table of Year-Animal-Element | Kunpen Lama Gangchen - NgalSo Dharma Centre" (<https://kunpen.ngalso.org/en/tibetan-calendar/tibetan-astrology-table-of-year-animal-element/>).
5. "Tibetan Astrology – Calendar Introduction | Kunpen Lama Gangchen - NgalSo Dharma Centre" (<https://kunpen.ngalso.org/en/tibetan-calendar/tibetan-astrology-calendar-introduction/>). *kunpen.ngalso.org*. Retrieved 2022-08-29.

## Further reading

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- Cornu, Philippe *Tibetan Astrology*. Shambhala, 1997. ISBN 1-57062-217-5.
- Desi Sangye Gyatso, Lochen Dharmasri and [Gyurme Dorje](#) *White Beryl: Tibetan Elemental Divination Paintings*. Eskenazi, 2001. ISBN 0-9539941-0-4
- Berzin, A. *Tibetan Astrology and Astronomy*. in Maitreya Magazine (Emst, Holland), vol. 11, no. 4 (1989).
- Berzin, A. *Tibetan Astro Studies*. in Chö-Yang, Year of Tibet Edition (Dharamsala, India), (1991).
- Namkhai Norbu Rinpoche *Key for Consulting the Tibetan Calendar*. Shang Shung Edizioni, 2003.

## External links

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- <https://mentseekhang.org/introduction-2/>

- Tibetan Astro Sciences: Basic Principles (<https://studybuddhism.com/en/advanced-studies/history-culture/tibetan-astrology/tibetan-astro-sciences>) - Dr. Alexander Berzin
- Digital Tibetan Buddhist Altar (<http://tibetanaltar.blogspot.com>) See the "Weekly Tibetan Astrology" feature and related background resources. Includes extensive information on yearly Tibetan astrology, inclusive of moving elements, spirits, parkha and mewa.

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